

SERVING PLAN 4 SERVING PLAN

Crispy Mozzarella-Stuffed Chicken

with Spinach Salad and Pesto Dressing

Butterflying chicken is a great technique for stuffing the meat with a variety of fillings. Our cheffy tips: Use a sharp knife and work slowly to slice through each breast horizontally, and you'll have restaurant-worthy results in no time. We stuff with mozzarella, dredge in egg and panko breadcrumbs, and shallow-fry until the crust is golden and crispy and the cheese is melted.

30–40 minutes 700 calories per serving

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Ingredients

- 9 ounces baby spinach
- ¾ pint grape tomatoes
- 2 lemons
- 2 tablespoons pesto
- ½ cup flour
- ½ teaspoon ground cayenne pepper
- 2 cups panko breadcrumbs
- 4 boneless skinless chicken breasts
- 4 ounces shredded mozzarella cheese

You'll need

- olive oil
- 2 eggs
- kosher salt
- black pepper
- 13 x 9" large baking dish (optional)
- 12" large pan

Recipe tips

Be sure to read through the entire recipe before you begin cooking. Trust us—you'll be glad you did!

Sealing the edge of each chicken breast with a little flour helps the cheese stay inside during cooking.

If the sides of each stuffed chicken breast don't cook through, use a pair of tongs to carefully tilt each one so that all sides get crispy and golden.

The chicken might have a slight odor as a natural reaction to its vacuum packing. USDA recommends cooking chicken to 165°F.

Questions? Email help@plated.com or call 855-525-2399. Visit plated.me/allergens for more information on dietary restrictions.

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1. Prepare ingredients

Rinse all produce. Pat **spinach** dry with paper towel. Halve **grape tomatoes**. Halve **1 lemon**; cut **remaining lemon** into wedges for serving. In a large bowl, whisk together **pesto**, **juice of 1 lemon**, and **2 tablespoons olive oil**. Set **pesto dressing** aside for Step 6.



2. Prepare breading

In a small bowl, measure out **1 teaspoon flour** and reserve for the next step. On a large plate, stir together **cayenne pepper** (it's spicy, so feel free to use less) and **remaining flour** to combine. In a large shallow bowl or baking dish, whisk **2 eggs**. Place **breadcrumbs** on a separate large plate.



3. Stuff chicken

Pat **chicken** dry with paper towel. Using a sharp knife, slice **chicken** open horizontally, keeping 1 edge intact, to resemble open books. Season **chicken** all over with **1 teaspoon salt** and **black pepper** as desired. Stuff **mozzarella** into **chicken**. Using your finger, moisten inner edge of **stuffed chicken** with **water**, then sprinkle with **reserved 1 teaspoon flour** (see recipe tip). Close to seal in cheese (don't worry if some cheese peeks out).



4. Dredge chicken

Keeping chicken closed to keep cheese inside, dredge **chicken** in **spiced flour**, gently shaking off excess. Dip in **egg**, allowing excess to drip off. Dredge in **breadcrumbs**, pressing to adhere.



5. Cook chicken

Heat **3 tablespoons olive oil** in a large pan over medium-high heat. When oil is shimmering, add **chicken** and sear, working in batches and adding oil in between as needed, until crust is browned, cheese is melted, and chicken is cooked through and no longer pink, 4–6 minutes per side (see recipe tip). Transfer **chicken** to a paper towel–lined plate and set aside to rest for about 5 minutes.



6. Plate chicken

Thinly slice rested **chicken**, if desired. Add **spinach** and **grape tomatoes** to bowl with pesto dressing and toss to coat. Divide **spinach salad** and **crispy mozzarella-stuffed chicken** among serving plates. Serve with **lemon wedges** for squeezing over. Enjoy!

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